

Project Title: Continuous UX Evolution of a Multi-Sided Event Platform

Timeline: 3+ months (Iterative CR Cycles)

Role: Product Designer

Team: BA, Development, QA, Stakeholders

Scope: Simplifying Complex Workflows Across Organizers, Venues, and Governments

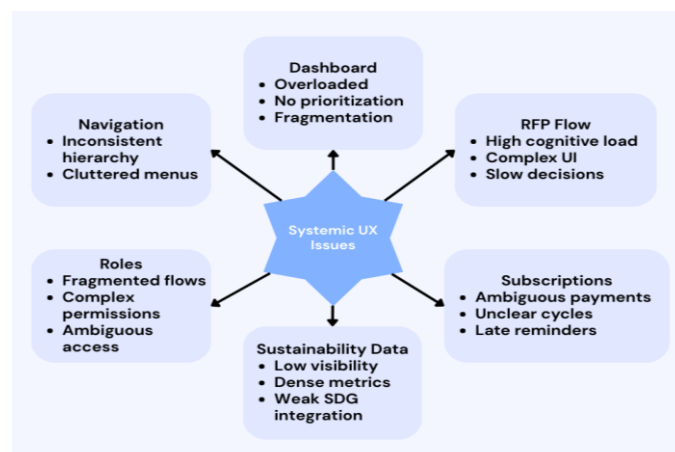
1. Overview

This platform connects event organizers with venues, cities, and countries while supporting sustainability benchmarking and subscription-based access models.

Over time, incremental feature releases across change request (CR) cycles led to increasing structural complexity. Rather than conducting a one-time redesign, I led a continuous UX evolution initiative aimed at simplifying workflows, improving hierarchy, and increasing system scalability, all within a live production environment.



2. Challenge



As the platform expanded, usability friction became systemic:

- Inconsistent navigation and weak public-site hierarchy
- Dashboard clutter without prioritization
- High cognitive load in the RFP (Request for Proposal) workflow
- Under-structured sustainability benchmarking (SDG integration)
- Payment and subscription ambiguity
- Fragmented experience across multiple user roles

The platform was growing functionally but lacked structural clarity.

The key challenge was: **How might we simplify complex, multi-role workflows without disrupting live users or slowing roadmap delivery?**

3. Constraints

- Active production environment (no full rebuild possible)
- Multiple stakeholders with competing priorities
- Complex permission-based role system
- High-density data (sustainability metrics & benchmarking)
- CR-based incremental release cycles
- Limited engineering bandwidth

This required adaptive UX thinking and phased improvements rather than sweeping redesign decisions.

4. Strategy and Hypothesis

I hypothesized that if we:

1. Rebuilt structural hierarchy
2. Reduced cognitive load in core workflows
3. Clarified dashboard prioritization
4. Modularized sustainability data
5. Simplified subscription and payment flows

Then we could:

- Improve workflow continuity
- Accelerate decision-making
- Increase usability across roles
- Strengthen long-term scalability

The focus shifted from visual refinement to structural clarity.

5. Execution Phases

Constraint	UX Response
Live production environment	Incremental CR cycles
Limited engineering bandwidth	Phased UX wins
High data density (SDG benchmarking, sustainability metrics)	Modularization
Complex multi-role permission system	Role-based workflow structuring
Stakeholder-driven roadmap pressure	Prioritized structural clarity over cosmetic redesign
Feature expansion across CR cycles	Progressive hierarchy refactoring
Dashboard clutter & workflow friction	Cognitive load reduction through prioritization

Phase 1: Public Experience & SEO Optimization

Problem

The landing page and marketing structure lacked clear CTA emphasis and content hierarchy, reducing discoverability and conversion clarity.

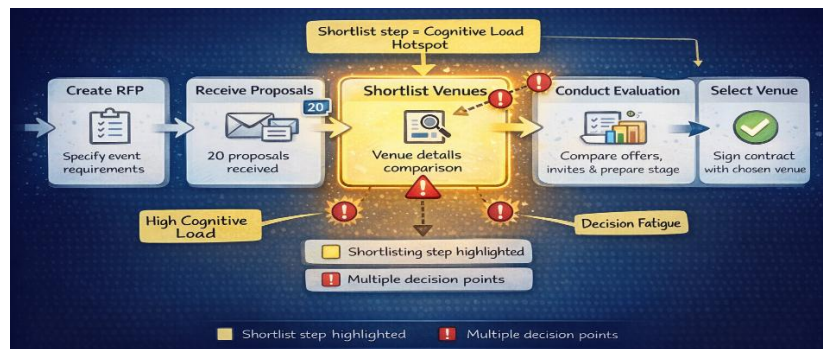
Actions Taken

- Reduced visual clutter
- Strengthened primary CTAs (Demo, Pricing, Signup)
- Rebalanced footer hierarchy
- Introduced scroll-navigation logic
- Created structured testimonial pages
- Designed clear error states (404, 502)
- Improved semantic structure for SEO

Result

Improved clarity, reduced visual competition, and strengthened acquisition pathways.

Phase 2: RFP Workflow Simplification



The RFP flow is the core value engine of the platform.

Problems Identified

- High cognitive load during shortlisting
- Poor information grouping
- Limited next-step visibility
- Weak admin oversight

Design Interventions

- Redesigned “View RFP” interface
- Improved venue shortlisting logic
- Added admin-level RFP controls
- Enhanced dashboard notification tiles
- Structured content into digestible sections

UX Focus

- Reduce decision fatigue
- Surface priority actions
- Improve workflow continuity

Outcome

Organizers and administrators gained clearer visibility and smoother proposal evaluation processes.

Phase 3: City & Country Sustainability Modules

A major expansion introduced SDG-based benchmarking and sustainability comparison tools.

UX Challenge

Balancing:

- High data density
- Multi-role access
- Complex filtering logic
- Readability

Decisions

- Structured city and country profile editing
- Introduced modular dashboard sections
- Prioritized key metrics visually
- Designed comparison dashboards

- Built structured filter logic
- Created sustainability initiative management flows

Outcome

Transformed overwhelming data into actionable benchmarking insights while preserving analytical depth.

Phase 4: Account, Login & Payment System Refinement

Problems

- Ambiguous login flows
- Unclear subscription lifecycle visibility
- Admin payment approval friction

Improvements

- Redesigned login with four clearly separated account types
- Structured subscriber dashboard hierarchy
- Designed direct payment approval flow
- Built partner management interface
- Improved subscription transparency across lifecycle stages

Result

Reduced friction, increased payment clarity, and improved administrative control.

6. System Communication & Feedback

To improve platform coherence:

- Designed structured email templates (RFP, invitations, notifications)
- Standardized brand alignment
- Improved edge-case and error states
- Strengthened system feedback loops

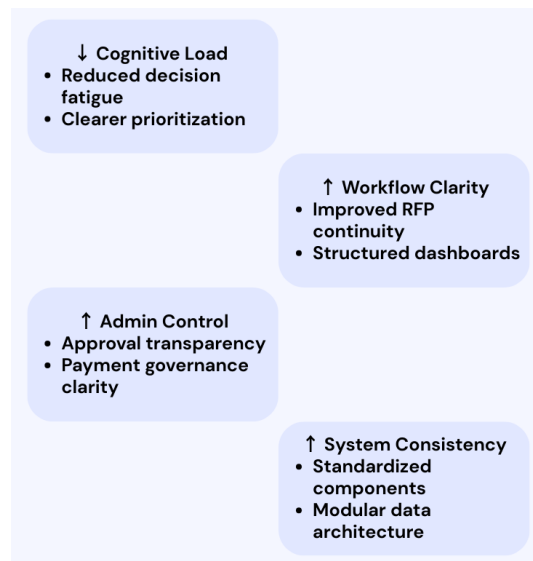
This ensured users received consistent guidance across touchpoints.

7. Tradeoffs

- Chose incremental structural clarity over disruptive redesign
- Balanced feature expansion with UX debt reduction
- Maintained data richness while simplifying presentation
- Prioritized scalability over short-term cosmetic improvements

Every decision required aligning roadmap velocity with usability improvement.

8. Impact



Across multiple CR cycles, the platform evolved into a more structured, scalable system.

Key improvements:

- Clearer navigation and acquisition pathways
- Reduced cognitive load in core workflows
- Stronger sustainability metric visibility
- Improved benchmarking usability
- Enhanced admin control over payments and subscriptions
- Greater structural consistency across user roles
- Improved system feedback and communication clarity

The platform matured from feature-accumulated complexity into a strategically structured product ecosystem.

9. Key Learnings

- Multi-sided platforms require systems thinking, not isolated UI fixes.
- Cognitive load reduction has measurable impact on workflow efficiency.
- Data-heavy features demand modular structure, not reduction.
- Continuous CR-based evolution requires disciplined prioritization.
- Structural clarity drives scalability more than visual polish.
- Communication states (emails, errors, dashboards) shape perceived product quality.